GRADE 3

Curriculum Book

Business ideas come from skills, hobbies, and needs

What I can do, what I love, and what I notice - that's where ideas live.

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Grade 3 - Curriculum Book

What I can do, what I love, and what I notice - that's where ideas live. This book is part of the Cash to Company K-12 program - a financial literacy and entrepreneurship curriculum aligned to Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, and CASEL standards.

For: *the 3rd-grade student (8 or 9 years old).* ***How to use:*** *one section per unit; activities, fill-in-the-blank, sort tasks, and reflection prompts. Students work mostly with a pencil and a partner. Cash shows up in the margins to ask one good question.*

Where ideas come from

Skills, hobbies, needs - and the eyes to notice.

Welcome from Cash

"*You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?*"

- CASH, GRADE 3

Hi. I'm Cash. I'm a coin with a face. I help kids figure out where business ideas come from.

This year you're going to learn one big thing: **business ideas come from skills, hobbies, and needs you already see.**

Skills are things you can do. Hobbies are things you love. Needs are things you notice are broken or missing. When you put them together, you get a business idea. You don't have to be born knowing how. You just have to start writing them down.

Here's a question I'll ask you a lot. Get used to it.

> CASH SAYS
>
> ***You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?***

Don't guess. Find out. That is the whole job this year.

Vocabulary Spine (your growing list)

> TRY THIS
>
> **Spot it in the wild**
>
> Walk through your house. Find three things somebody made or sold. Write the name of one. Who do you think bought it, and why?

Add to this page every week. Keep it neat — you'll use it on Capstone Day.

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS	MY EXAMPLE OR PICTURE
Skill	Something I can do.	
Hobby	Something I love to do.	
Need	Something somebody is missing.	
Customer	A person who would use what I make or do.	
Idea	A picture of what I might do.	
Web	A drawing that connects ideas.	
Match	When two things go together.	
Brainstorm	Write down many ideas before judging.	
Problem	Something that needs fixing.	
Evidence	What I saw, heard, or counted.	
Real-sounding	Could happen in real life.	
Defend	Say why I picked it.	
Cost	What I paid.	
Revenue	What I took in.	
Profit	What's left.	
Price	What I charge.	
Logo	A small picture for my business.	
Name	What I call my business.	
Message		

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS	MY EXAMPLE OR PICTURE
	What my logo and name tell the customer.	
Plan	The steps in order.	
Step	One part of the plan.	
Honest	True. I can show how I know.	
Misleading	Sounds true but isn't.	
First try	My starting version.	
Fix	The change I made.	

CASH SAYS

Cash says: *Words are tools. Pick the right one and the job gets easier.*

Unit 1 — Skills, Hobbies, Needs (Weeks 1–8)

Activity 1.1 — My Skills + Hobbies + Needs Web

WORDS TO KNOW

Skill
Something you have practiced enough to be good at.

Hobby
Something you do for fun, on your own time.

Need
A problem somebody has that they want solved.

Customer
The person who pays - not the person you wish would pay.

Idea
A skill, a hobby, or a need turned into a way to help someone.

Fill 3+ branches in each circle. Stay specific. Names go off the page — needs are about the situation, not a kid.

SKILLS (things I can do):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____ *(bonus)*

HOBBIES (things I love to do):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____ *(bonus)*

NEEDS (things I notice are missing or broken — no kid's name):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____ *(bonus)*

Now circle two ideas your web suggests. A business idea is a match between something on your web and somebody who would be glad you did it.

> CASH SAYS
>
> ***Cash says:*** *Don't say "I have nothing." If you take care of a pet, that's a skill. If you remember everyone's name, that's a skill. If you can listen when a kid is upset, that's a skill. Write it down.*

Activity 1.2 — Trio Charter

> MATH MOMENT
>
> **Tally five**
>
> Ask five people: 'Would you buy this?' Tally yes and no with marks. Five marks each row. Did more say yes or no?

Fill in with your trio:

- **Trio name: _____**
- **Capstone idea (one sentence): _____**
- **Roles:**
- CEO (keeps everyone on track): _____
- Designer (makes things look right): _____
- Money Keeper (tracks the numbers): _____
- Sales (talks to the customer): _____

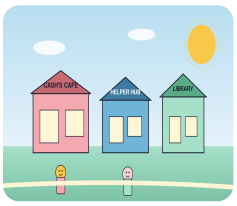
- **One rule we agree to follow: ____**

> CASH SAYS
>
> ***Cash says:*** *Specializing is what lets a small team do real work.*

Activity 1.3 — Promise Sentence

CASH ASKS

"*What did they actually say? Tell me one real sentence.*"



PEOPLE YOU CAN ASK

Five real customers

Family, neighbors, classmates, teachers, the person at the corner store. Five real people beats one good guess.

Take one circled idea from your Web. Turn it into a promise. Be **specific** — not "kids," but "third-grade kids who lose their pencils."

> CASH SAYS
>
> "*My business will help ___ by ___.*"

How will I know my customer wants this? *(write one way)*

> CASH SAYS
>
> ***Cash says:*** *Everyone is a way to say nobody. Who's the first one?*

Reflection 1 — End of Unit 1

FAMILY TALK

Skill, hobby, or need?

At dinner, name one skill, one hobby, and one need somebody at the table has. Could any of them turn into a tiny business?

Answer in 2–3 sentences:

1. What's one skill of mine I didn't know was a skill until this unit?
2. What's one need I see now that I didn't notice before?
3. Who do I think my customer is? Just a guess is fine for now.

Unit 2 — Five Ideas From One Problem (Weeks 9–18)

Activity 2.1 — The Class Brainstorm

CASH ASKS

"*Five ideas beats one idea. Pick the most real-sounding one.*"

Problem: _____ *(your teacher writes it on the board)*

In 4 minutes, write every idea you hear. Don't judge yet. Quantity is the goal.

#	IDEA
1	
2	
3	
4	
5	
6	
7	
8	
9	
10	

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> ***Cash says:*** *Five beats one. Every time.*

Activity 2.2 — My Solo 5-Idea Page

Problem: _____ *(your teacher writes it on the board)*

Write 5 ideas. Each one different. If you stall at idea 3, make idea 4 the opposite of idea 1. Make idea 5 a sillier version. Ideas don't have to be good yet.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

Now pick one. Which one is most *real-sounding*? (A kid in this room could try it next week.)

> **CASH SAYS**
> "*I picked #_* ***because*** _____."

Activity 2.3 — Defense Paragraph (Trio)

CASH SAYS

"*First tries get something wrong. The fix is what makes you a real entrepreneur.*"

Use the frame. Use at least 2 of the 3 reason types: **I have the skill · I see the need · Kids would actually use it.**

> **CASH SAYS**
> "*My idea is* ___. ***My first reason is*** ___. *My second reason is* ____. *So we pick this one.*"

Bonus sentence (advanced):

> **CASH SAYS**
> "*One way I could be wrong is* ____."
> ***Cash says:*** *Most adults skip the reason. You won't.*

Reflection 2 — End of Unit 2

1. Why is *5 ideas* better than *1 idea*?

2. Which of my 5 ideas almost won? What's one thing it had going for it?
3. What's one way our trio's pick could be wrong?

Unit 3 — The Lemonade Math + the Logo (Weeks 19–27)

Activity 3.1 — The Three Words

Fill in the Frayer square for **profit.**

WHAT'S LEFT AFTER I PAY THE COST. REVENUE MINUS COST.	*(DRAW A STACK OF COINS WITH A SMALLER STACK LABELED "COST" BEING LIFTED OFF)*
Example: I paid $4 for the can. I sold 16 cups for $1. Profit = $16 − $4 = $12.	**Non-example:** Profit is **not** how much I sold. That's revenue.

Activity 3.2 — Cost / Revenue / Profit Worksheet

For each scenario, fill in **Cost · Revenue · Profit.** Show your work.

Scenario 1 — Lemonade. Can of mix costs $4. You poured 16 cups. Sold each for $1.

- Cost: $_____
- Revenue: __ × $_ = $___
- Profit: $__ − $_ = $___

Scenario 2 — Cookies. You spent $3 to make 10 cookies. Sold each for $1.

- Cost: $_____
- Revenue: $_____

- Profit: $_____

Scenario 3 — Bracelets. Beads cost $6. You made 5 bracelets. Sold each for $2.

- Cost: $_____
- Revenue: $_____
- Profit: $_____

Scenario 4 — Dog walking. Flyers cost $0 (paper from school). Walked 4 dogs. Charged $5 each.

- Cost: $_____
- Revenue: $_____
- Profit: $_____

Scenario 5 — Zine. Printing cost $2. Made 5 zines. Sold each for $1.

- Cost: $_____
- Revenue: $_____
- Profit: $_____

Scenario 6 (advanced) — The slow Tuesday. Lemonade can $4, made 16 cups, only sold 8.

- Cost: $_____
- Revenue: $_____
- Profit: $_____
- *Did the stand make money? _____. What does that tell me? ____*

In your own words: **profit means ____**

> CASH SAYS
>
> ***Cash says:*** *Revenue is loud. Profit is true. Pay attention to what's left.*

Activity 3.3 — My Trio's Capstone Profit

For our hypothetical Capstone day, here's our math:

- We make/sell: _____
- Cost (one number): $_____
- Price per unit: $_____
- Number of units we hope to sell: _____
- Revenue: __ **× $_ = $**___
- Profit: $__ **− $_ = $**___

Two-question test (advanced):

- *What if we only sell half?* Profit: $_____
- *Did we still make money?* _____

Activity 3.4 — Logo + Name

Trio activity. Designer leads. Everyone adds something.

Our business name: _____

Our logo (draw in the box, 4 inches square):

```
+-------------------------+
|                         |
|                         |
|                         |
|                         |
|                         |
|                         |
+-------------------------+
```

What does the name tell a customer? _____

What does the logo tell a customer? _____

> CASH SAYS
>
> ***Cash says:*** *A logo and a name are messages. They tell the customer something before you say a word.*

Reflection 3 — End of Unit 3

1. What was the trickiest part of the math?
2. If a customer saw our logo and didn't read the name, would they still know what we do? Why or why not?
3. One thing I'd change about our name: _____

Unit 4 — Run the Day, Tell the Truth, Fix the Flop (Weeks 28–36)

Activity 4.1 — Run-of-Day Strip

In order, list the 4–6 steps your trio will run on Capstone Day.

#	STEP (ONE VERB)	IF WE SKIP IT, _____ BREAKS.
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		

CASH SAYS

Cash says: *Plans are not fancy. Plans are written down.*

Activity 4.2 — Honest or Misleading Sort

For each claim, circle **HONEST** or **MISLEADING.** Then write one reason.

#	CLAIM	HONEST / MISLEADING	REASON
1	"100% juice" (and the bottle is 100% juice)	H / M	
2	"Juice drink" (a drink with juice in it)	H / M	
3	"All-natural" on something with food coloring	H / M	
4	"Best lemonade in school" with no proof	H / M	
5	"Sold 14 cups Tuesday" (and it's true)	H / M	
6	"Everyone loves it"	H / M	
7	"World's #1" (no proof)	H / M	
8	"Free upgrade" (no upgrade exists)	H / M	
9	"Trusted by Mrs. Lee's class" (with permission)	H / M	
10	"Healthier than soda" (no proof)	H / M	
11	"$1 a cup" (and that's the price)	H / M	
12	"Made with care" (true, but low info)	H / M	

Three tip-offs that something is misleading:

1. The word *everyone* (or *nobody*).
2. A claim with no number to back it up.
3. A word that sounds healthy or fancy but doesn't actually mean anything.

Audit your own Capstone words. Read your name, logo, and any tagline you've drafted. Run the three tip-offs. Anything you need to fix?

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> *Our fix: ____*
>
> ***Cash says:*** *Honest claims build long-term customers. You can choose what kind of business you're running.*

Activity 4.3 — First-Try Fix Reflection

Read this short story:

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> *"In a Cash story, a kid named Mae started a bracelet business. On Day 1 she made 20 bracelets and put them out at recess for $3 each. Nobody bought any. She watched. Then she noticed two things. First, kids didn't have $3 in their pockets at recess. Second, none of the bracelets had names on them — the kids couldn't tell which one was which. The next day Mae did two things. She lowered the price to $1, and she wrote each kid's name on a tag. She sold 8 bracelets in 10 minutes."*

Answer:

1. What did Mae's first try get wrong? Name 1 thing.
2. What was Mae's fix? Name 1 thing.
3. Now apply it to our trio. *One thing our first try would probably get wrong: ____*
4. *One fix we'd make: _____*

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> ***Cash says:*** *First tries get something wrong. That is normal. The fix is what makes you a real entrepreneur.*

Activity 4.4 — Capstone Day Stand Setup Checklist

Check each box when it's done.

- [ ] Logo + name visible from 3 feet
- [ ] Cost / Revenue / Profit worksheet readable
- [ ] Run-of-day strip taped to the table
- [ ] First-Try Fix reflection in the Capstone Journal, open
- [ ] 90-second pitch on a notecard (sales has it)
- [ ] Trio knows who answers the visitor's question (CEO)
- [ ] Money keeper can say the profit number out loud

Activity 4.5 — The 90-Second Pitch (Sales)

Use the words **customer, problem, plan, profit.**

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> "*Hi. We are* ___***. Our customer is*** ___*. Their problem is* ___***. Our plan is*** ___*. If we run our day right, our profit will be $*__***. The thing we'd change for next time is*** ___*. Thank you for visiting our stand.*"

Say it twice before Capstone Day. Time it. Aim for under 90 seconds.

Reflection 4 — End of Year

Answer in your Capstone Journal:

1. What's one skill I started this year *not* knowing I had?
2. What's one thing my first try got wrong?

3. What was my fix?
4. If I ran this stand for real next month, what would I change?
5. What's one question I want Grade 4 to help me answer?

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> ***Cash says:*** *Most adults skip parts of this year. You didn't. You are 8 or 9 years old, and you already know more about how a business works than most grown-ups in line at the coffee shop. Keep going.*

End-of-year word check

Without looking back, write a sentence using each anchor word: **customer · problem · plan · profit.**

1. *Customer:* _____
2. *Problem:* _____
3. *Plan:* _____
4. *Profit:* _____

When you're done, check the Vocabulary Spine. Did you use the word the same way?

A note from Cash to take home

You started this year with three circles on a page. By the end you had a logo, a name, a price, a plan, an honest message, and a fix for what didn't work. That's a business. You're not done — you'll never be done — but you're standing.

In Grade 4, the question gets sharper. Cash is going to ask: *who buys, how much, how many, what does it cost, and what's left?* You already know the *what's left* answer. That's profit. You learned it this year.

See you in Grade 4.

Senior expert upgrade pack — Deliberate practice (Grade 3)

Practice A — Three volumes, one product

Pick a product. Compute cost, revenue, profit at three volumes.

Product: ____ Cost per unit: $__ Price per unit: $____

UNITS SOLD	REVENUE	COST	PROFIT
5			
10			
25			

What pattern do you see? _____

Practice B — Two logos, one message

Draw a logo for the same business in two different ways.

LOGO VERSION 1 (YOUR FIRST TRY)	LOGO VERSION 2 (TRY TO MAKE IT CLEARER)

Which logo would a customer understand faster? Why? ____

Practice C — Honest or misleading?

Read each ad claim. Circle Honest or Misleading, and write one reason.

1. "*Made with 100% real fruit juice.*" — Honest / Misleading because: ____
2. "*Doctors recommend this!*" (no source given) — Honest / Misleading because: ____

3. "*Limited time only — ends Sunday.*" — Honest / Misleading because: ____
4. "*Now with 30% more!*" (more of what?) — Honest / Misleading because: ____

Practice D — The Skills I Could Build column

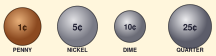
Add this column to the Skills + Hobbies + Needs web. For each business idea, name one skill you don't yet have but could build.

IDEA	SKILL I HAVE	SKILL I COULD BUILD

FROM CASH

What I do, what I love, what I notice

Three questions. Three sentences. Three ideas. That's how a business starts - not with a logo, with a list.



KEEP IT REAL

Real customers. Real money. Real lessons.

Every page in this book points back to one habit: ask a real person, listen to the real answer, count the real numbers. The rest is decoration.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

What Grade 3 hits

This curriculum book aligns to the following K-12 standards. See the *Master Standards Alignment Map* for the full grade-band crosswalk.

Jump$tart 3-5
Spending and saving - earning money, choices, opportunity cost.

CEE NS3
Productive resources, scarcity, and choice.

CCSS-MATH 3.MD
Measurement and data - survey customers, tally results.

CCSS-ELA SL.3.1
Engage in collaborative discussions - pitch and feedback.

CASEL Self-Awareness
Identify strengths, interests, and values.

C3 D2.Eco.1.3-5
Compare benefits and costs of choices.

FROM CASH

One last thing

"*You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?*"

- CASH, GRADE 3

You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it? — Cash

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